



SPINS A YARN — *Beautify El Paso* President Andy Cohen, right, entertains a group awaiting the opening of the association meeting at Radford School for Girls Saturday afternoon. From left are Mrs. Shirley

Christensen, recording secretary; Mayor Bert Williams, guest speaker, and Miss Marjorie Graham, Radford principal and hostess for the meeting.

Beautify El Paso Association Hears Mayor On Urban Renewal

Mayor Bert Williams Saturday took his Urban Renewal message to a group which he described as "people who care" when he spoke before the Beautify El Paso Association in Radford School for Girls.

Declaring that 99 per cent of the nation's Urban Renewal projects are "going beautifully," Williams pointed to the need to eliminate 1,200 tenements that are housing 30,000 El Pasoans in conditions that add to costs of law enforcement, health and education functions.

He cited conditions in which 50 to 60 families have two or three bathrooms. The mayor noted Judge R. E. Thomason had called for the elimination of these tenements in 1929.

He said those he had talked to in Las Cruces and Albuquerque, N.M., and San Antonio and Waco, Tex. were pleased with their programs. He said the mayor of Waco was prepared to speak in behalf of the project here.

Williams described work already done and projects planned to provide more parks, beautified medians,

purier air, cleaner buses and more attractive buildings.

With regard to his platform promise to plant 200,000 trees in El Paso, the mayor said not too many had been planted but the City has acquired tree planting equipment and is ready to start on the project.

Plans to push his palm tree planting project and broaden it to include other varieties of trees suitable for this area were described by the mayor. He agreed climatic conditions may prove the City wrong in some of its selections, but only by experimenting can the city determine what is best for the area. He said many palms have survived 40 to 50 years in this area.

He told the group a park is being developed along Levee Road, a strip 100 yards wide by approximately 14 miles. Known as River Park it will be lighted, planted and equipped with cook stoves.

Currently under consideration, said Williams, are palm-lined roads to beautify El Paso. He explained he is not trying to make El Paso some-

thing it is not but rather trying to develop its potential.

Referring to the recent city court case with American Smelting and Refining Co., the mayor indicated that the firm was doing much better in the clean air field now and many other firms are voluntarily going to work on their pollution problems, leading to a much cleaner and healthier El Paso.

In discussing public transportation problems and the pollution caused by buses, Williams said he City has received a \$30,000 federal grant to study the feasibility of the City taking over all four bus companies and the international bridges now serving the City. He noted that El Paso is the only city in the nation being served by four bus companies. He described the buses as "the worst in the nation."

It is now an accepted belief that all planets of the solar system probably came into being at the same time.